

## Lesson plan

### Slide;

1. NA
2. Recall questions
3. Learning journey
4. Share answers
5. Introduce images for focus of this lesson, take ideas about which church will be looked at
6. TEACHER TALK share answer
7. TEACHER TALK introduce the LDS
8. Share video, answer questions, feedback
9. Share answers
10. TEACHER TALK link tasks
11. Give out reading sheet, answer questions, feedback
12. Share answers
13. Set up info hunt, collect answers to questions, feedback
14. Answers
15. Answers
16. Answers
17. Answers
18. Answers
19. Answers
20. Answers
21. Answers
22. Share information about the church today
23. Reflect on how different/similar the LDS are to other groups so far, use sheet from last lesson for help
24. Potential answers

By the end of the lessons students need to know;

1. The origins of the LDS; Joseph Smith and the first vision
2. The persecution of the early church members and this leading to displacement
3. The unique nature of some LDS practices including; baptism for the dead, meeting houses and temples, missionaries, the Word of Wisdom and ongoing revelation



1. How are people baptised into the Catholic Church?
2. How are people baptised into the Baptist Church?
3. What are the differences between these?



# Unit 5 - Why don't all Christians express their religious tradition in the same way?

## Core concepts



**Belief**



**Wisdom  
and  
authority**



**Community**

1. How diverse is Christianity in the USA?



1

2. What are the largest Christian groups in the USA?



2

4. What is the history and development of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints?



4

6. Why is the Prosperity Gospel controversial?



6

3. What do fundamental Christians believe about creation?



3

5. What is the history and development of the Amish?



5

7. How are religion and politics connected in the USA? \*



7



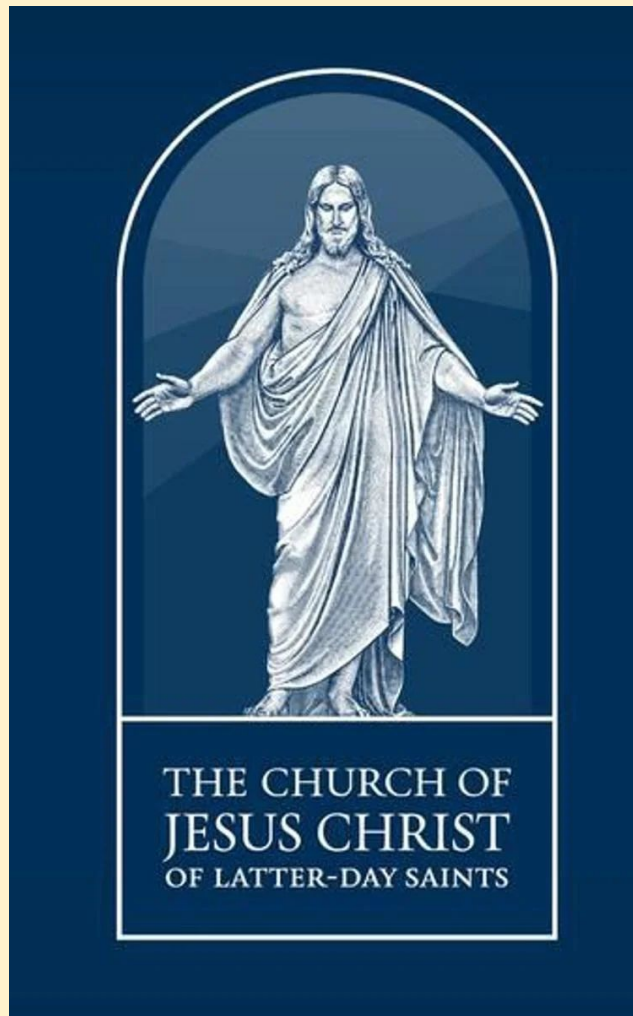
1. How are people baptised into the Catholic Church?
  - a. **Water is poured on the head, special words are said, babies are baptised and adults if they join the church.**
2. How are people baptised into the Baptist Church?
  - a. **Full body immersion, baptism is a choice - only happens to teenagers and above.**
3. What are the differences between these?
  - a. **Baptists baptise adults after they choose, whereas Catholics baptise children. Baptism is full body, but Catholics pour water on the head.**



Which Christian group do you think we will be looking at today?



# What is the history and development of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints?



The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-Day Saints  
Also known as the LDS for short, or sometimes called Mormons. Although members of the LDS generally reject this name.

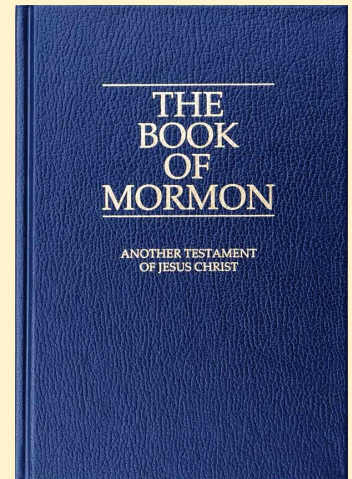
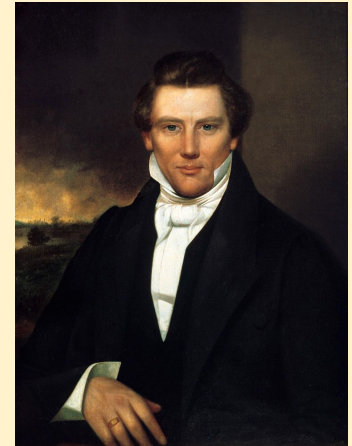
**Lesson question; What is the history and development of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints?**

Topic question; Why don't all Christians express their religious tradition in the same way?

# What is the history and development of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints?

## The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints (LDS)

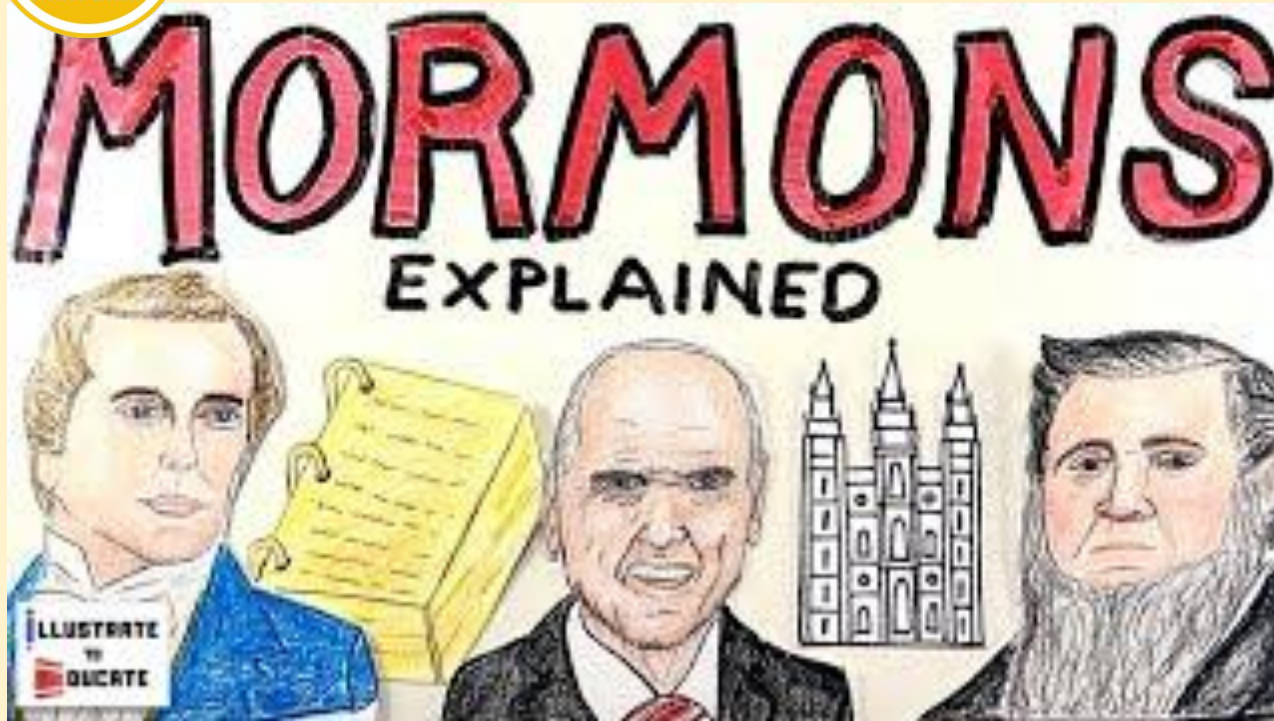
- The LDS is a Christian denomination founded in the 1830s in the United States by Joseph Smith.
- Believers follow the Bible and the Book of Mormon, a text Smith said restored the original Christian faith.
- The LDS Church is known for its missionary work, strong focus on family, and unique practices like temple worship and health codes.
- Members often live in close-knit communities and take part in religious and community activities.



**Lesson question; What is the history and development of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints?**

Topic question; Why don't all Christians express their religious tradition in the same way?

# What is the history and development of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints?



1. Who was Joseph Smith? What happened to him?
2. What did Joseph Smith find?
3. Who led the LDS after the death of Joseph Smith?



**Persecution** – Being treated unfairly for your beliefs.

**Polygamy** – Being married to more than one person.

**Martyrdom** – Dying for your beliefs.

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# What is the history and development of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints?



1. Who was Joseph Smith? What happened to him?
  - a. **Joseph Smith was the founder of the Church of Latter Day Saints, he had a religious experience called the first vision - he went to pray for guidance about which church to join and said he was visited by God and Jesus, who said not to join any church as they were all corrupt.**
2. What did Joseph Smith find?
  - a. **In 1827 he found golden plates buried in a hill and translated these into the Book of Mormon.**
3. Who led the LDS after the death of Joseph Smith?
  - a. **Brigham Young**

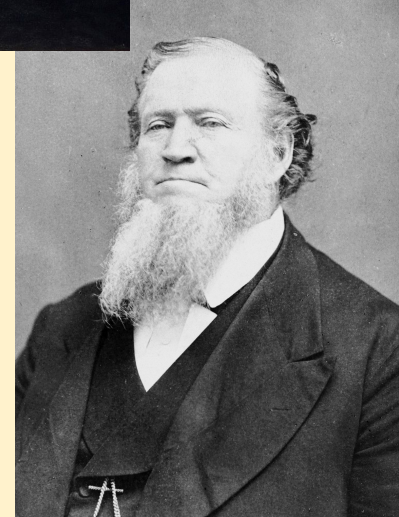
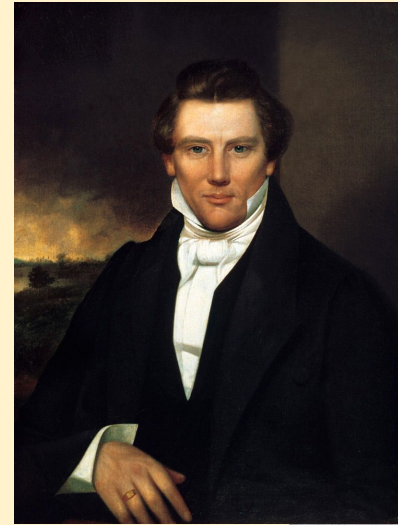
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# What is the history and development of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints?

## What happens next?

We know how the LDS began with Joseph Smith - but what happened next to the developing church?



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# What is the history and development of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints?

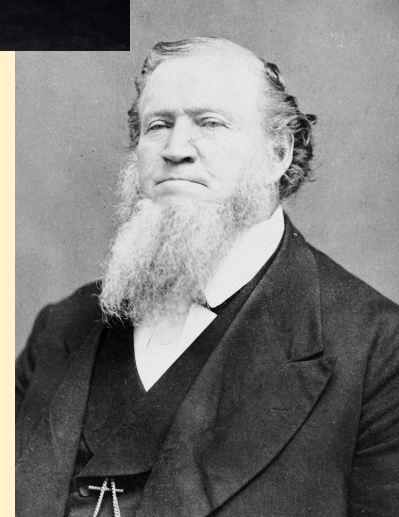
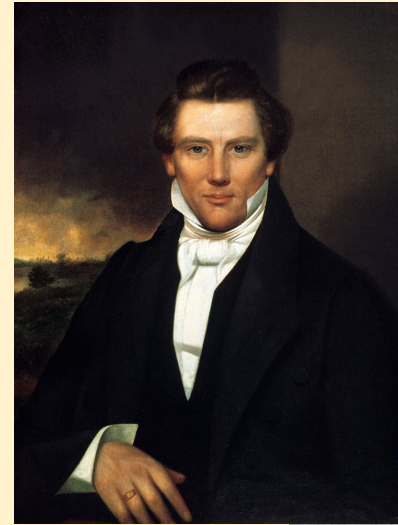


**Read the sheet and highlight the answers to the questions.**

1. **Who** founded the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints and **when**?
2. **Why** were early Latter-day Saints **persecuted** in the 19th century? Give **two** reasons.
3. What **happened** to Joseph Smith in **1844**?
4. **Who** became the **leader** of the Church after Joseph Smith died?
5. **Where** did Brigham Young **lead** the Latter-day Saints to **live**?

**Now record your answers;**

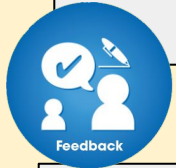
1. How did persecution affect the early LDS Church?



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# What is the history and development of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints?



1. Who founded the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints and when?  
**a. Joseph Smith, 1830s**
2. Why were early Latter-day Saints persecuted in the 19th century? Give two reasons.  
**a. Beliefs, social practices, they were growing quickly, many Americans didn't trust the new religion**
3. What happened to Joseph Smith in 1844?  
**a. He was jailed and killed by a mob**
4. Who became the leader of the Church after Joseph Smith died?  
**a. Brigham Young**
5. Where did Brigham Young lead the Latter-day Saints to live?  
**a. To the West, to Utah**

**Now record your answers;**

1. How did persecution affect the early LDS Church?  
**a. It forced the new Church to move frequently and search for a safe place to live and practice their faith.**

**Lesson question; What is the history and development of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints?**

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# What is the history and development of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints?



Now you know how the LDS began, let's explore some of the key practices of the church.

Around the room there are 8 posters with key information, and questions.

You should read the information and answer the questions in the matching box on your sheet.



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Topic question; Why don't all Christians express their religious tradition in the same way?

# What is the history and development of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints?



## Origins and Joseph Smith

1. Who was Joseph Smith and why is he important?
  - a. **Joseph Smith founded the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints in 1830. Latter-day Saints believe he restored the original Christian Church.**
2. What did Joseph Smith say happened to him?
  - a. **He said God and Jesus appeared to him in a vision, and an angel named Moroni showed him golden plates that he translated into the Book of Mormon.**

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# What is the history and development of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints?



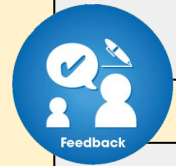
## Sources of authority

1. What books do Latter-day Saints believe are sacred?
  - a. **They follow the Bible, the Book of Mormon, and the Doctrine and Covenants.**
2. What is a living prophet?
  - a. **A living prophet is a Church leader who Latter-day Saints believe receives guidance from God today.**

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# What is the history and development of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints?



## **Baptism and ordinances**

1. At what age are LDS members baptised, and why at that age?
  - a. **They are baptised from age 8, because they believe this is when a child can understand right and wrong.**
2. What is baptism for the dead?
  - a. **It is when a living person is baptised on behalf of someone who has died, giving them the chance to accept the faith in the afterlife.**

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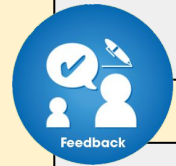
## Temples and ceremonies

1. What happens inside temples?
  - a. **Members take part in marriage ceremonies, baptism for the dead, and special religious promises.**
2. Why is temple marriage so important for LDS members?
  - a. **Because they believe families can be together forever through temple marriage.**

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## Family life and community

1. What is family home evening?
  - a. **A weekly time for prayer and discussion with the family.**
2. What do missionaries do?
  - a. **They share their faith with others.**

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## Health code and daily practices

1. What is the Word of Wisdom?
  - a. **A health code that teaches healthy living and caring for the body.**
2. What do LDS members avoid?
  - a. **Alcohol, tobacco, illegal drugs, coffee, and tea.**

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## Ongoing revelation

1. Who leads the LDS today?
  - a. **A living prophet, currently Dallin Oaks.**
2. What does the prophet receive?
  - a. **Revelation to guide the Church today.**

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# What is the history and development of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints?



## History and persecution

1. Why did the early LDS face persecution?
  - a. **Because many people disagreed with their beliefs.**
2. Why did members move to Utah?
  - a. **So they could practise their religion freely.**

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## What is the church like today?

### Ongoing revelation and modern prophets

Latter-day Saints believe that **God still speaks today** through a **living prophet**, a leader who receives guidance from God for the whole Church. After the death of **President Russell M. Nelson in 2025**, **Dallin H. Oaks** became the 18th president and prophet of the LDS Church. Prophets guide members on how to live their faith today, continuing the tradition started by Joseph Smith.

### The LDS Church around the world

The Church continues to grow globally. By the end of 2024, there were about **17.5 million members** worldwide, in over **31,000 congregations** and nearly **200 temples**. In the United Kingdom, there are over **185,000 members** with multiple congregations and two temples.

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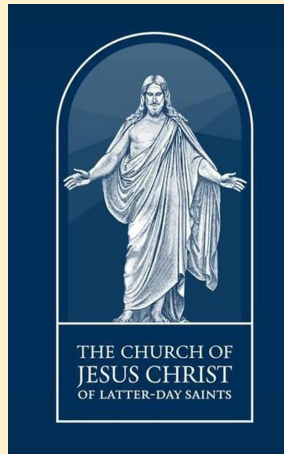


Practice

How similar or different is the LDS from the other Christian churches we've looked at in the USA?



|                        | What do they believe? | Who or what guides them? | How do they worship? | How do they live? |
|------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------|----------------------|-------------------|
| Catholic               |                       |                          |                      |                   |
| Evangelical Protestant |                       |                          |                      |                   |
| Methodist              |                       |                          |                      |                   |
| Baptist                |                       |                          |                      |                   |
| Latter Day Saints      |                       |                          |                      |                   |
| Amish                  |                       |                          |                      |                   |



Use this sheet form last lesson to help you

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## Similarities

## Differences

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